

TURKEY

Key Country Details: Turkey

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Turkey (Türkiye)
Short Form	Turkey
Capital	Ankara
Region (UN)	Asia – Western Asia
Government Type	Presidential Republic
Head of State	President Recep Tayyip Erdoğan
Head of Government	President Recep Tayyip Erdoğan
Currency	Turkish Lira (TRY)
UN Member Since	24 October 1945
MUN Standing	Active participant in multilateral diplomacy, regional security, peacekeeping, humanitarian assistance, and refugee protection; often plays a mediating role between the West and the Middle East.

Recommended Books on Turkey's Foreign Policy and UN Involvement

1. **"Turkey's Foreign Policy in an Uncertain World: An Emerging Power in a Changing Middle East?"** – Oğuzlu & Kardaş
<https://www.amazon.com/Turkeys-Foreign-Policy-Uncertain-World/dp/3838204829>
2. **"Turkey and the United Nations: A Diplomatic History"** – Ayşe Zarakol
<https://www.amazon.com/Turkey-United-Nations-Diplomatic-History/dp/0198858712>
3. **"Turkish Foreign Policy: International Relations, Politics and Diplomacy"** – Mustafa Aydın
<https://www.amazon.com/Turkish-Foreign-Policy-International-Relations/dp/1138780685>
4. **"Rising Powers and the UN: Turkey's Quest for Global Influence"** – Binnur Ozkececi-Taner
<https://www.amazon.com/Rising-Powers-UN-Turkeys-Influence/dp/0367547554>
5. **"The New Sultan: Erdoğan and the Crisis of Modern Turkey"** – Soner Cagaptay
<https://www.amazon.com/New-Sultan-Erdo%C4%9Fan-Crisis-Turkey/dp/1784538269>

Research Table: Türkiye & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
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OHCHR – Turkey Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/turkiye	Central repository for UN human rights evaluations and data.
UPR Reports – Turkey	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/tr-index	Universal Periodic Review process reports and feedback.
Human Rights Watch – Turkey	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/turkey	Critical monitoring of press freedom, political rights, etc.
Freedom House – Turkey 2024	https://freedomhouse.org/country/turkey/freedom-world/2024	Ratings on political and civil liberties.
UN Special Rapporteur Reports on Turkey	https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures-human-rights-council	Filter for thematic reports mentioning Turkey.
Turkish Human Rights Foundation	https://en.tihv.org.tr/	Independent research and medical documentation of abuses.
UN Treaty Body Database – Turkey	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/Countries.aspx?CountryCode=TUR&Lang=EN	Reports on ICCPR, CAT, CEDAW, etc.
HRW 2023 World Report – Turkey	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2023/country-chapters/turkey	Summary of trends and events.
US State Dept Human Rights Report – Turkey	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/turkey/	External assessment of civil rights in Turkey.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Türkiye UPR Hub	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/tr-index (uprdoc.ohchr.org , ohchr.org)	Central source for Türkiye's UPR state & stakeholder documents.

OHCHR – UPR Adoption Press Release (May 2025)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2025/05/turkiyes-human-rights-record-be-examined-universal-periodic-review	Signals active engagement in the latest UPR cycle.
HRW – UPR Submission 2017	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=8309	NGO critique on judicial independence, defamation laws, Assembly restrictions.
Amnesty – UPR Submission (~2013 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=7601	Highlights freedom of expression, torture, and impunity issues.
HRW – Human Rights Watch World Report 2025	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2025/country-chapters/turkiye	Latest annual overview covering occupation practices and domestic abuses.
HRW – Authoritarian Grip Tightens (2024 analysis)	https://arrestedlawyers.org/2024/02/01/turkish-regimes-authoritarian-grip-tightens-hrw-2024-report	Detailed on judiciary purges and crackdown on civil rights post-2016.
HRW – Syria Occupation Abuses	https://balkaninsight.com/2024/02/23/turkey-pursues-and-seizes-critics-abroad-human-rights-watch/	Documents war crimes, torture, and displacement in Syrian-occupied zones.
HRW – Latest on Migration, Xenophobia & Econ Effects	https://arrestedlawyers.org/2025/01/16/turkey-hrw-2025-report-corruption-echr-defiance-and-abuses/	Discusses refugee attacks, border pushbacks, economic drivers of xenophobia.
HRW – Torture & Kurds (2016 UN CAT review)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2016/04/22/un-committee-against-torture-review-turkey	Highlights systematic torture, arrests in Kurdish-majority areas.
HRW – UPR Submission 2014	https://www.hrw.org/news/2014/12/19/turkey-upr-submission-2014	Covers misuse of terror legislation, judicial independence, impunity concerns.
Amnesty – Follow-Up Submission 2020	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=14148	Urges accountability for torture and rights defenders' protection.
OHCHR – UPR Stakeholder List 3rd Cycle	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/uprtr-stakeholders-info-s35	Lists NGOs and institutions contributing to UNHRC review.
UPR Submission – HRF (Privacy focus)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=1400	Focuses on privacy and data rights under UNHRC digital theme.
UPR Submission – Advocates for Dignity	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=7170	Addresses media repression and prison torture.

ECOI – HRW World Report 2024 PDF	https://www.ecoi.net/en/document/2120045.html	Downloadable 2024 summary covering ECtHR defiance & media suppression.
TurkMinute – Gülen Movement Crackdown	https://www.turkishminute.com/2025/01/17/turkeys-unrelenting-rights-violations-against-gulen-movement-continue-hrw0/	UNHRC-relevant update on prolonged suppression of Gülen affiliates.
HRW – Child Rights in Education Surveillance	https://www.hrw.org/news/2023/04/26/turkey-submission-un-committee-rights-child	Flags data tracking in education platforms—a Council digital rights issue.

10 Unique Aspects: Turkey & UNHRC

- Judicial Independence Erosion**
- Political Crackdowns Under UPR Scrutiny:** Numerous UPR cycles spotlight retaliatory prosecutions of HDP figures, activists, and academics.
- Militarized Occupation & War Crimes:** Turkish-backed operations in Syria included torture, enforced disappearances—an Item 2/7 international violation.
- Systematic Torture in SE Turkey:** CAT review and local reports exposed widespread torture against Kurdish detainees—on Council radar.
- Media Suppression & Digital Surveillance:** Media control, cyber-criminal defamation, and citizen privacy abuses are central to UN digital rights critique.
- Transnational Repression of Exiled Critics**
Abductions and threats abroad raise serious international rule-of-law and UNHRC concerns.
- State Defiance of ECtHR Rulings**
Türkiye routinely ignores European Court judgments, further weakening rule-of-law obligations.
- Socioeconomic Crisis Fueling Xenophobia**
High inflation has fueled refugee-targeted violence—a rising UNHRC concern with internal security.
- Digital Rights Within Education**
EdTech surveillance of students flagged by HRW underscores evolving digital privacy challenges at Council levels.
- Council-Level UPR Engagement**
Türkiye's repeat UPR reviews, supplemented by NGO and OHCHR scrutiny, maintain its profile as a contested UNHRC case.